LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer

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github.com/lvh-data-example

PROFILE

Senior Data Engineer with 9 years of experience designing, building and operating production data platforms and cloud data warehouses at scale across logistics, e-commerce and payments. Strong Python and SQL background across Airflow, dbt, Spark, Kafka, Snowflake, Redshift and AWS, with experience in dimensional modelling, data quality, data contracts and warehouse performance optimisation.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer - Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. (logistics marketplace), Rijeka *03/2022 - present*

- Own the ingestion layer of the company data platform: ~140 Airflow DAGs loading from Postgres, MySQL, Salesforce and 3rd-party APIs into Snowflake.
- Migrated approximately 300 stored procedures into dbt models with tests and documentation; reduced the nightly warehouse build from 5h10 to 1h35.
- Introduced data contracts between product teams and the data team using JSON Schema and CI checks.
- Built a Kafka-based event pipeline using Kafka Connect and Snowpipe Streaming for approximately 30M shipment-tracking events per day, achieving under 2 minutes end-to-end latency at p95; added a dead-letter topic and replay tooling for failed events.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from Postgres with Debezium CDC into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.
- Reduced Snowflake costs from approximately $38k/month to $24k/month through warehouse sizing and auto-suspend.
- Participate in the data-platform on-call rotation, one week in six.
- Mentor two mid-level data engineers; run the weekly data platform office hours.

Data Engineer - Kovalent Pay (payments startup), Zagreb *09/2019 - 02/2022*

- Built PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR to match bank settlement files against internal ledgers, processing approximately 1.2 TB of raw S3 files daily and reducing manual month-end reconciliation from approximately 3 days to 4 hours.
- Designed the Redshift warehouse schema (star schema, 30+ fact/dimension tables) used by finance and risk.
- Set up data quality checks with Great Expectations on critical finance tables.
- Wrote internal Python library for S3/Glue catalog access used by 4 teams.

Junior Data Engineer / BI Developer - Adria Retail Group, Split *06/2017 - 08/2019*

- Maintained SSIS packages and T-SQL ETL into an on-prem SQL Server warehouse.
- Built Power BI reports for store operations (40+ stores).
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS jobs to Python scripts scheduled with cron.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science (Data Science track) - Northgate Technical University, 2017
Thesis: Incremental materialized views for analytical queries

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate (May 2024)

SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, Bash
Data Platforms, Warehousing & Modelling: Airflow, dbt, Spark (PySpark), Kafka, Kafka Connect, Snowflake, Redshift, PostgreSQL, Great Expectations; dimensional modelling, data quality, data contracts, CDC, warehouse performance optimisation, CI/CD, streaming and batch processing
Cloud, Infrastructure & CI/CD: AWS (S3, EMR, Glue, Lambda, IAM), Docker, Terraform (basic), GitHub Actions
BI: Power BI, Looker (basic)

OPEN-SOURCE & TECHNICAL CONTRIBUTIONS

Airflow provider contributor — fixed a pagination bug and added tests; 2 merged pull requests (2023).
Speaker, 'Data contracts without the hype,' regional data meetup (2024).

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native), English (C1), German (B1)